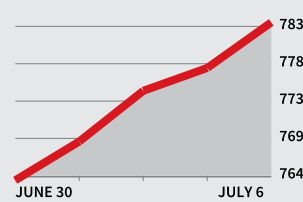


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 78285.07 (+521.16)

IN FOCUS



	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24430.35	+159.50
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	21.25	+0.14
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.39	+0.18
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	145000.00	-758
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	233158.00	-700

BOLSTERING TIES.

PM Modi begins Indonesia, Australia, New Zealand tour to deepen defence, trade and Indo-Pacific co-operation **p3**



MAJOR RELIEF.

Kharif paddy acreage sees remarkable recovery on 35% surplus rain during July 1-5 **p10**

QUICKLY.

DEBT DISPUTE

Two vendors drag Ola to NCLT over ₹40 crore dues



Bengaluru: E2W maker Ola Electric is facing insolvency proceedings after two suppliers approached the NCLT, alleging payment defaults of about ₹40 crore. Sterling E-Mobility Solutions Ltd, the EV components arm of listed Sterling Tools Ltd, and Aneolve Mando eMobility Pvt Ltd, part of the Anand Group, have sought the initiation of the corporate insolvency resolution process against Ola Electric Technologies Pvt Ltd. **p8**

ANOTHER CO-OP EFFORT

Centre plans pan-India co-operative life insurer

New Delhi: Union Co-operation Minister Amit Shah on Monday announced that a pan-India co-operative life insurance company will soon be set up. It will be the fifth national-level co-operative entity launched by the NDA government, following the establishment of dedicated bodies for exports, seeds, organic products and taxi services. **p3**

AAI builds new runway into pilot training business

FLIGHT PLAN. Move aligns with India's projected need for 30,000 pilots in 15-20 years

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

The Airports Authority of India (AAI) is preparing to enter the country's pilot training ecosystem by establishing Full Flight Simulator (FFS) and Type Rating Training Organisation (TRTO) facilities across its airport network, marking a strategic diversification beyond its traditional role as an airport developer and operator, sources told *businessline*.

TENDER ISSUED

A request for proposal (RFP) document, reviewed by *businessline*, showed that AAI had invited bids to appoint a consultant for preparing a comprehensive implementation strategy for establishing FFS and TRTO facilities at suitable airports under its network.

The move assumes significance as it signals the entry of a government-backed entity into a segment that has so far largely been dominated by private training providers.

Besides, this comes at a

TAKING WINGS

- State airport operator invites consultant to chart roadmap for simulator and pilot training infra
- AAI eyes pilot training as a new business vertical beyond airport operations
- Initiative aims to boost domestic simulator capacity amid training slot shortages



time when India is expected to witness a sharp rise in demand for trained commercial pilots.

According to the Ministry of Civil Aviation, the country currently has 10,261 valid Airline Transport Pilot Licence (ATPL) holders. The government has projected that India will require around 30,000 pilots over the next 15-20 years to support the induction of more than 1,700 aircraft already on order by India's airlines.

To meet this growing requirement, the Centre has been promoting the establishment of pilot training centres, Flying Training Organisations (FTOs) and simulator-based training infrastructure to strengthen the

aviation skilling ecosystem.

At present, India's rapidly expanding airline industry has been grappling with limited flight simulator capacity, forcing airlines to compete for slots and, in some cases, send pilots overseas for type-rating programmes.

Consequently, several Indian airlines, including IndiGo and Air India, have already established simulator training centres. Additionally, private training providers, such as CAE and L3Harris, also operate FFS facilities to cater to the growing training requirements of airlines.

However, setting up such infrastructure requires significant capital investments with a modern FFS typically

costing upwards of ₹100 crore per unit, apart from the expenditure on associated infrastructure, maintenance and regulatory compliance.

SCOPE OF WORK

The AAI tender document states that the objective is to develop a sustainable business model that enables the body to participate in the growing aviation training market while leveraging its airport infrastructure.

It added that the consultant will undertake an assessment of the market demand, identify suitable airport locations, evaluate infrastructure requirements, recommend partnership models and prepare detailed financial projections covering capital and operating expenditure, as also revenue streams and return on investment.

The consultant will also examine domestic as well as international demand for simulator-based pilot training and type-rating programmes while identifying aircraft types for which simulator demand is expected to remain strong over the coming years.

In a first, alternative fuel vehicles top 40% of registrations in June

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Alternative-fuel vehicles (AFVs) captured a record 40.35 per cent share of India's passenger vehicle (PV) market in June, driven by all-time high electric vehicle (EV) sales, according to data released by the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA) on Monday.

The combined share of compressed natural gas (CNG), hybrid and electric vehicles crossed the 40 per cent mark for the first time, with passenger EV retail sales touching a record 31,823 units.

PETROL VEHICLES DIP

The share of petrol- and ethanol-powered passenger vehicles fell to 43.63 per cent in June from 47.68 per cent a year earlier.

In contrast, CNG-powered vehicles continued to gain ground, with their market share rising to 24.33 per cent from 20.82 per cent.

Passenger EVs accounted for 7.75 per cent of total PV registrations in June, up from 4.8 per cent a year ago, while hybrid vehicles were up marginally to 8.27 per cent from 7.97 per cent, the FADA report showed.



NEW LAUNCHES

The surge in EV sales was aided by new launches from market leaders Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles and Mahindra & Mahindra, followed by JSW MG Motor India and VinFast India. Maruti Suzuki India and Toyota Kirloskar Motor also entered the space earlier this year with the e-Vitar and Urban Cruiser Ebella, respectively.

The electrification trend was visible across other segments as well.

Electric two-wheelers accounted for 10.6 per cent of registrations in June, up from 7.34 per cent a year ago, while the share of petrol-powered models declined to 89.33 per cent from 92.44 per cent.

In the three-wheeler segment, the share of EVs increased to 64.08 per cent from 58.44 per cent a year earlier, while CNG's share dropped to 22.2 per cent

from 29.22 per cent. Overall vehicle retail sales across segments rose 22 per cent year-on-year to 25.57 lakh units in June from 20.99 lakh units a year ago, FADA said.

Passenger vehicle registrations grew 28.63 per cent to over 4.1 lakh units, while two-wheeler registrations rose 21.22 per cent to about 18.28 lakh units during the month.

MONSOON SCARE

Looking ahead, dealers said retail demand will depend on the monsoon recovery, kharif sowing and supply chains remaining stable amid the West Asia ceasefire and softer crude oil prices.

"Two-wheelers should benefit from the rural income cycle once sowing is complete, passenger vehicles from the festival build-up beginning with Ganesh Chaturthi and Onam in September, and commercial vehicles from sustained goods movement and infrastructure activity," said FADA President CS Vigneshwar.

However, he cautioned that dealers see El Nino-led impact on rural demand as the biggest risk, followed by further price hikes hitting affordability and inventory build-up.

Led by smartphones & electronics, TN posted fastest growth in merchandise exports in FY26

Sindhu Hariharan
Sourashis Banerjee
Chennai

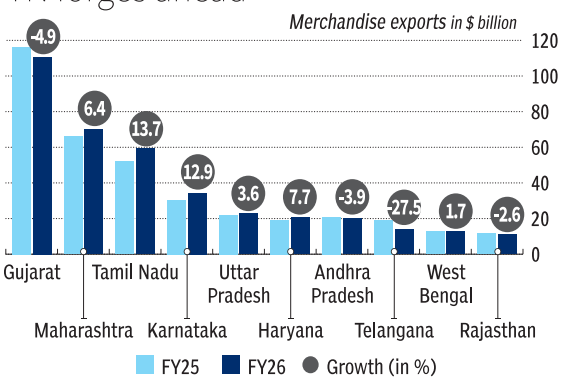
Tamil Nadu emerged as the fastest-growing major merchandise exporter in FY26, driven by its booming smartphone and electronics manufacturing ecosystem.

The State's merchandise exports rose 13.7 per cent year-on-year to \$59.3 billion, despite global trade tensions and geopolitical uncertainties, according to the latest Commerce Ministry data.

Tamil Nadu also retained its position as India's largest electronics exporter for the third consecutive year, with electronics shipments surging 36 per cent to \$19.9 billion.

The State now accounts for 42 per cent of the country's electronics exports.

TN forges ahead



Source: DGCIIS

TOP SPOTS

While Gujarat and Maharashtra continued to be the country's top two merchandise exporters in absolute terms, Gujarat recorded a decline in exports and Maharashtra posted only marginal growth in FY26.

Karnataka registered the second-highest growth among major exporting States, with exports rising over 12 per cent to \$34.4 billion, while Telangana saw exports contract 27 per cent.

According to Megha Arora, Director-Economics,

India Ratings & Research, electronics has emerged as India's third-largest export category after engineering goods and petroleum products, accounting for over 11 per cent of the country's export basket.

Tamil Nadu has strengthened its position in India's export landscape, increasing its share of national merchandise exports to 13.7 per cent in FY26 from 8.5 per cent in FY22, while retaining its third position nationally.

The gains were driven by higher exports of electronics, engineering goods and chemicals. In contrast, Gujarat's share of India's merchandise exports declined to 25.6 per cent in FY26 from 30.7 per cent in FY22, reflecting weaker shipments of petroleum products and gems and jewellery.

Visually **p2**

How luxury cars are becoming easier to own

Instead of the full vehicle price, buyers finance only 3 years' expected depreciation

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

When 51-year-old Gurugram-based multinational executive Rajan Wadhwa set out to buy a luxury car this year, he thought he had found the perfect antidote to India's rising vehicle prices. Living at DLF Camellias and driving barely 10-12 km a day to DLF Cyber City, he fits the profile luxury carmakers prize most — affluent, urban and low-mileage.

Instead of taking a conventional loan, Wadhwa opted for BMW's 360° programme, which cut the monthly outgo on a ₹50-70 lakh BMW X1 or electric iX1 from about ₹1.5 lakh to ₹70,000-85,000. The catch: he financed only the vehicle's expected depreciation over three years, not its full purchase price.

BMW also guaranteed a



pre-agreed residual value at the end of 36 months. Wadhwa can then either pay the balloon amount and keep the car, refinance the balance or simply return it.

These structured ownership plans combine guaranteed future value (GFV), balloon financing and assured buyback options, enabling customers to pay only for the period they use the vehicle rather than owning it outright.

Luxury brands including BMW, Mercedes-Benz, Audi and Lexus now offer such programmes, while some manufacturers are extending the concept

through leasing-led ownership models.

ACCESS OVER ASSET

Wadhwa is far from an outlier. BMW estimates India's structured ownership market at ₹4,500-5,000 crore, while Mercedes-Benz Financial Services has built an assets-under-management (AUM) book of about ₹1,500 crore.

Industry executives estimate penetration has nearly doubled over the past three years, from 18-20 per cent of luxury vehicle sales in FY24 to 35-40 per cent now. In luxury EVs, nearly two out of every three vehicles are sold through such programmes.

The model has one caveat: Most plans assume annual usage of about 15,000 km, with higher mileage reducing the guaranteed buyback value.

"We are seeing a clear

shift in customer behaviour, especially in the premium and emerging EV segments, where buyers increasingly want flexibility, lower monthly ownership costs and confidence around future value," said Hardeep Singh Brar, President and CEO, BMW Group India.

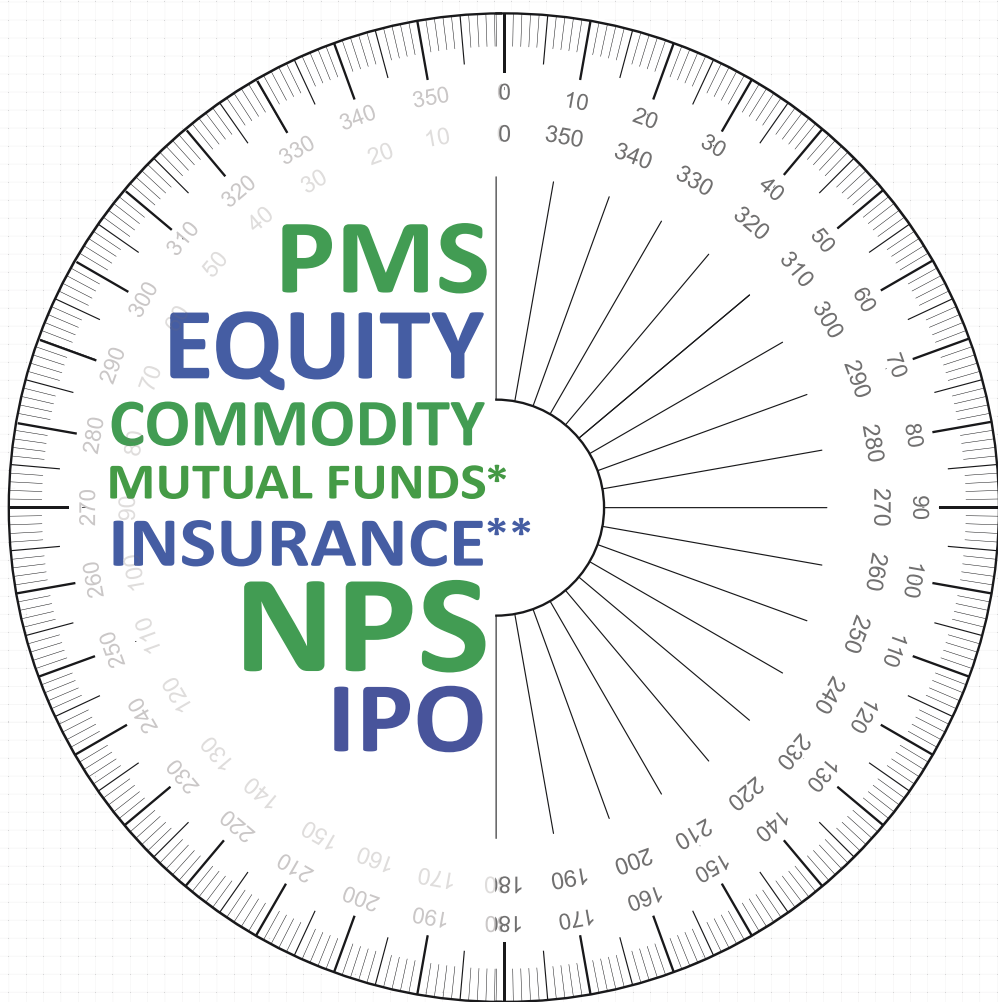
RIDE RETHINK

The concept is now spreading beyond luxury brands into the ₹15-35 lakh premium passenger vehicle segment.

Volkswagen and Škoda offer assured buyback programmes on models such as the Taigun, while Maruti Suzuki is planning Guaranteed Future Value schemes for the upcoming e Vitara. Tata Motors, JSW MG Motor and Mahindra are also expanding similar ownership models across their premium EV portfolios.

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NRI banking issues

Database, dissemination need a revamp

Manas R Das

Following the June 5 decision by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) to mobilise Foreign Currency Non-resident (Bank) [FCNR (B)] deposits almost on a war footing, the media witnessed considerable debates and discussions on the topic.

However, lack of an adequate published database, both at macro and micro levels, held back deeper analyses which, if not rectified, will continue to thwart further research on the larger subject of Non-resident Indian (NRI) business (deposits and loans) by banks.

The RBI publishes data on NRI business by banks on a monthly, quarterly, half-yearly and annual basis. However, most of the data are covered in the monthly and annual publications, as briefly discussed below:

NRI DEPOSITS

Monthly: The RBI Bulletin gives the outstanding and year-on-year (y-o-y) flow data on NRI deposits, scheme-wise – (a) FCNR (B) Accounts, (b) Non-resident External Rupee Accounts and (c) Non-resident Ordinary Rupee Accounts - in US Dollar (USD). The data relate to the current year’s month/s. It also provides the outstanding amount at March-end of the previous year.

The Bulletin contains two more tables: “India’s Overall Balance of Payments” and “Standard Presentation of BoP (Balance of Payment) in India as per BPM6”¹ which present quarterly figures on total NRI deposits

Annual: (a) “Handbook of Statistics on the Indian Economy” (Handbook) contains time-series data on NRI deposits, scheme-wise, in four tables. Two tables contain outstanding balances, and the other two provide y-o-y inflows/outflows — all in USD and INR and (b) An Appendix Table in “The Report on Trend and Progress of Banking in India” (RTPBI) gives, scheme-wise, the outstanding amount of NRI deposits for the Financial Year (FY) to which the RTPBI relate and the FY preceding it, in INR.

NRI LOANS

An Appendix Table in the RTPBI gives the outstanding amount of loans to non-residents for the FY to which the RTPBI relate and the FY preceding it, in INR.

The monthly report “Sectoral



DATA. In the public domain

Deployment of Bank Credit” clubs loans against FCNR (B) and Non-Resident Non-Repatriable Rupee Deposits with all ‘Advances against fixed deposits.’ The same report, with updation, is published in the RTPBI, Handbook and “Statistical Tables Relating to Banks in India (Other Tables).”

Banks give very sparse data on NRI business.

Given the significance of FCNR (B) deposits, the database must be bolstered. This will not help in policy formulation but also product development for NRIs.

STEPS TO IMPROVE

For NRI deposits data must be give on — number of accounts, bank- and scheme-wise number of accounts and balance outstanding, share of top 20 deposits, balance outstanding per country of origin, scheme-wise maturity pattern, cost of NRI deposits and their term deposit rates.

Likewise for NRI loans data on Loans to NRIs against their term deposits, scheme-wise: Number of accounts and amount outstanding and on loans outstanding data must be provided for bank-wise distribution, purpose-wise classification, maturity pattern and non-performing loans.

Sale of third party products to NRIs: Relevant data on the products sold must also be provided.

Banks are privileged to be repositories of humongous data in respect of their customers. Therefore, quite possibly, data on many of the aforementioned parameters are already available in their systems, or with the RBI collected from them through various Returns, statutory and otherwise.

The crucial need, however, is their regular ‘dissemination’ in a user-friendly manner in the public domain. RBI and banks should establish standardised systems and procedures for it.

The writer is a former Assistant General Manager (Economist), SBI. Views expressed are personal

MACROSCAN.



CP CHANDRASHEKHAR, JAYATI GHOSH

At the end of June, India’s National Statistical Office released figures on the Index of Industrial Production (IIP) for the month of May. The headlines were reassuring. Month-on-month annual industrial growth had recovered from a low of 3 per cent in March to 4.9 per cent in April and 5.1 per cent in May 2026. The downside, however, is that the May growth rate is significantly below the high of 7 per cent registered in November 2025.

Monthly growth rates can be deceptive, given the observed volatility of month-on-month growth rates (Chart 1). Moreover, the IIP, while a useful lead indicator that is made available within a month of the reference period, has its inadequacies. Like much of India’s aggregate statistical indicators, it misses out on trends in the large and economically significant informal sector. Data collection is also plagued by non-reporting respondents, resulting in unsatisfactory statistical adjustments for missing values that have an undue influence on the aggregate. So quarterly or annual averages may be more representative of actual trends.

Those numbers are disappointing. Quarterly growth rates, having risen from 3.5 per cent in the quarter ending June 2025 to 5.4 per cent in quarter ending September 2025, have fallen to 4.3 and 3.9 per cent respectively in the subsequent two quarters of 2025-26 (Chart 2). Annual averages too point to a deceleration of industrial growth from 6.8 per cent in 2023-24 to 5.7 per cent in 2024-25 and 4.3 per cent in 2025-26 (Chart 3). These trends also corroborate the sense based on reports from the ground that, barring individual sectors like automobiles, industrial growth is losing momentum.

NEW SERIES

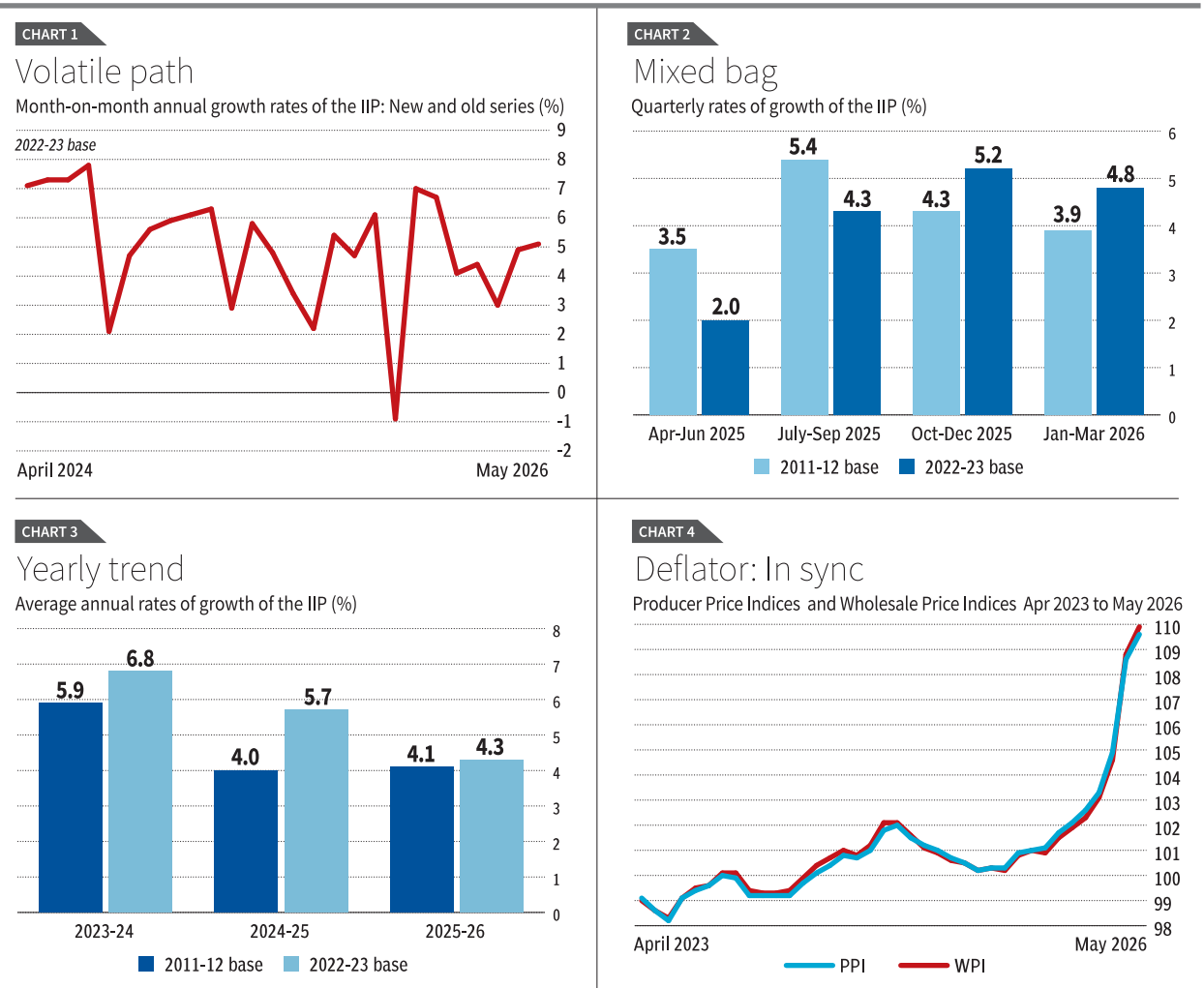
There is one more reason why these numbers are noteworthy. The IIP estimates issued in May by the NSO, are part of a new series of IIP numbers with 2022-23 as base that replaces the earlier series with 2011-12 as base. Such periodic revisions of the base year are routine. The intent of such revision is to capture the changed structure of the industrial sector both in terms of the relative weights or importance of industry groups covered, as well as to accommodate new groups that have emerged and gained significance, and often are the more dynamic segments of the industrial sector.

The new series (2022-23 base) with 455 item groups, has 56 more groups than the series with 2011-12 base, 45 of which are in the manufacturing sector. In addition, the new series has expanded coverage and includes minor minerals, rare earth minerals, gas supply, water supply, sewerage and waste management. Estimates using the new base are available from April 2023.

A question that arises is whether the revision of the base year for the index has influenced growth trends in a way that suggests greater dynamism when changes in industrial structure are taken account of. The evidence here is mixed.

The IIP and India’s industrial growth story

The new series of the Index of Industrial Production with 2022-23 as base too points to a growth deceleration



To start with, while the quarterly growth rates for the two quarters ending December 2025 and March 2026 as indicated by the new series are higher than in the old series, the opposite is true for the two quarters ending June 2025 and September 2025 (Chart 2). That is, the inclusion of new and additional items has not unequivocally raised the rate of industrial growth in recent quarters.

In fact, on balance, the new series points to a medium-term deceleration in growth not visible in the earlier series. Annual rates of growth of industry as revealed by the new series decelerated from 6.8 per cent in 2023-24 to 5.7 per cent in 2024-25 and 4.3 per cent in 2025-26. On the other hand, growth as per the old series while showing a sharper fall from 5.9 per cent to 4.0 per

The index revision aimed at providing a more accurate picture of industrial performance than the old series did, seems to suggest that the sector has not performed all too well in recent times

cent between 2023-24 and 2024-25, rose marginally to 4.1 per cent (Chart 3). Thus, while the new series points to higher annual rates of growth of industry over this period than the older series, it indicates a persisting deceleration in growth which the old series does not.

In sum, the index revision aimed at providing a more accurate picture of industrial performance than the old series did, seems to suggest that the sector has not performed all too well in recent times.

DEFLATOR IMPACT

There is however one more statistical shift that may be influencing the picture on industrial performance provided by the new IIP series. Though the IIP is supposed to be an index that captures industrial movements based on shifts in the quantity of production, the output of 234 of the of the 463 item groups included in the IIP basket, which together account for 36.02 per cent of the total weight, is captured in value-based production data. This requires the nominal values of output to be deflated to take account of price changes and isolate the movements in quantities.

For this purpose, the old series relies

on the indices of wholesale prices of the different groups to deflate the nominal figures.

But starting in June the NSO has decided to shift to using Producer Price Indices to deflate the value figures incorporated in the revised index, and adopted the same procedure for all the historical numbers from April 2023. This change in deflator could have affected the output ‘values’ in ways that can account for some of the trends in growth as per the new IIP and the difference, if any, of those trends when compared with the estimates yielded by the index with base year 2011-12.

However, this additional element of “noise” affecting the numbers does not seem to be significant. As Chart 4 shows, for the period under consideration, the movements in the producer price and wholesale price indices track each other almost perfectly. The change in deflator used cannot account for difference in trends as revealed by the old and new series.

In sum, to the extent that the new series of industrial production indices better represents actual production trends, there is reason to argue that industrial growth in India has been losing momentum, corroborating the message derived from other indicators.

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TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

July 7, 2006

PM puts divestment on hold

The Prime Minister, Dr Manmohan Singh, today put on hold all divestment decisions and proposals, including sale of shares in public sector firms Neyveli Lignite Corporation (NLC) and National Aluminium Company Ltd (Nalco), after one of its key allies, the DMK, threatened to withdraw support to the UPA Government if it went ahead with sale of NLC shares.

NTC seeks nod to sell 93 acres

National Textiles Corporation (NTC) hopes to get clearance soon for the sale of about 93 acres of surplus mill land in Mumbai. The Corporation has sent sale proposals of nine mills (some only in parts) to the State Government and the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai (MCGM) for final clearance.

Tata stocks riding on acquisitions, consolidation

A combination of factors ranging from acquisitions to impact of global consolidation in their respective sectors and the benefit of riding this wave while hailing from a respectable business house, has triggered investor interest in select Tata company stocks. Shares finding fancy included those of Tata Steel, Tata Coffee, Tata Tea, Tata Power and Tata Chemicals.

Sweltering heat threatens US holiday events, power grids

Naureen S Malik
Joe Wertz

A searing heat dome will push electricity demand across the eastern US toward record levels over the July 4 holiday, testing power grids as air conditioners run full tilt on a busy World Cup weekend.

The dangerous heat wave is forecast to bring triple-digit temperatures to many US cities, including New York. About 152 million people spanning Kansas to Maine were under extreme heat warnings on

Friday, according to the National Weather Service. Heat advisories stretch from Michigan as far south as Alabama.

Hundreds of temperature records — for daytime highs and warm overnight lows — are likely to be tested through the weekend, according to the US Weather Prediction Center. That’s straining power systems across the region, with more than 62,000 customers without electricity, data from PowerOutage.com show.

The country’s largest grid serving

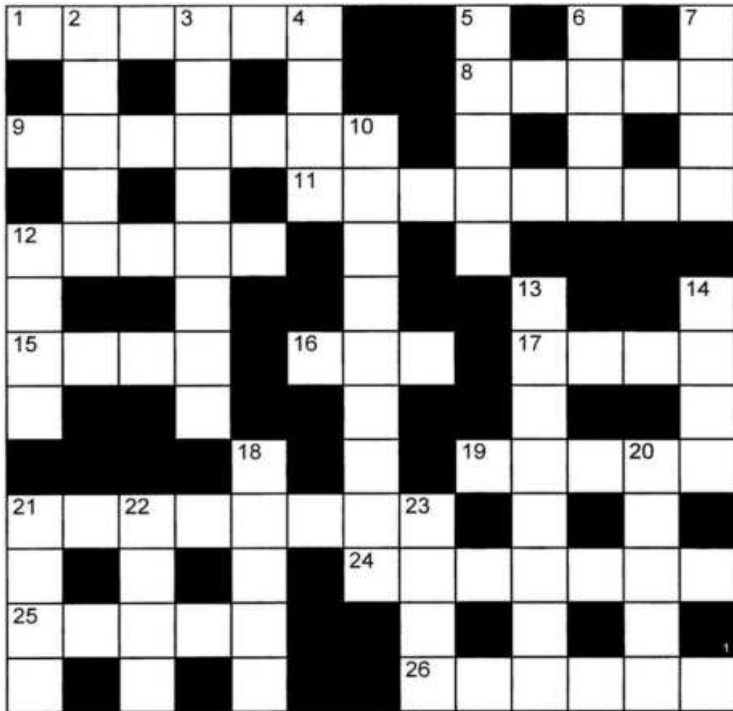
nearly a fifth of Americans from Washington to Chicago is operating in an emergency — at the lowest of three levels — for the third consecutive day. PJM Interconnection LLC ordered all power plants to be available at maximum levels for the entire day as it faces a capacity emergency.

While electricity usage is set to ease slightly Friday amid holiday travel, cooling demand may spike again as the hot and humid conditions persist. The risk of failures at power plants or other

critical equipment rises with high sustained demand.

The sprawling heat dome adds another major complication: grids that typically rely on each other for spare supplies may limit supplies to neighbours to keep their systems stable. Temperatures in Central Park spiked to 100F (38C) on Thursday — making it the hottest day in the city since 2012. Oppressive temperatures and humidity are forecast across the city and the eastern half of the US through the weekend. BLOOMBERG

● BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2687



EASY

ACROSS

- Stationary, stable (6)
- Sound (5)
- College head (7)
- Showy and worthless stuff (8)
- Allotted part (5)
- Girl (4)
- Espionage agent (3)
- Again, afresh (4)
- Improve one’s mind (5)
- Think, deliberate on (8)
- Renewed performance of play (7)
- Northern sea-duck (5)
- Different people from us (6)

DOWN

- Flashlight (5)
- Comrade (Russian) (8)
- Those taking part in play (4)
- Dwarf, goblin (5)
- Smooth nails, etc (4)
- Gainsay, declare not to be true (4)
- Wind instrumentalist (9)
- Under-surface of foot (4)
- Bread snack (8)
- Swing side to side (4)
- 45 degree joint (5)
- Intuitive discernment (5)
- Character on stave (mus) (4)
- Knot, swelling (4)
- Do it again (4)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

- Though stationary, it may interfere with reception (6)
- One is so upset by what one hears (5)
- Cathedral church dignitary gets troops out around five (7)
- Wordless stuff produced by two-thirds of 10 on the railway (8)
- Have a part of this index of trade on the Stock Exchange (5)
- Girl hasn’t begun to show form (4)
- Mole finishes his crop early (3)
- If old-fashioned, we get backing afresh (4)
- Deify in order to improve the mind of one (5)
- Think it legally placed on football field and in credit (8)
- Another showing of Ravel perhaps around six (7)
- Duck one found in broken reed (5)
- Different ones from sort he makes up (6)

DOWN

- In Toc-H regulars began to see the light (5)
- Ivor changes hats with comrade in Russia (8)
- Those in play who behave like belfounders (4)
- Pithy saying from a model standing in the garden (5)
- If it’s up to the French, they’ll produce a dossier (4)
- Say one didn’t die: one would have to leave New York (4)
- Swan – not the mute – might give one a blast (9)
- Flatfish comes between one and the ground one walks on (4)
- Snack course between work and study (8)
- Influence, for argument’s sake, around the West (4)
- Joint episcopal dignity (5)
- Faculty for nosing out sudden blaze, by the sound of it (5)
- Musical symbol used in song-cycle frequently (4)
- A swelling running ABCFGH? (4)
- Embarrassed, having nothing to work at it again (4)

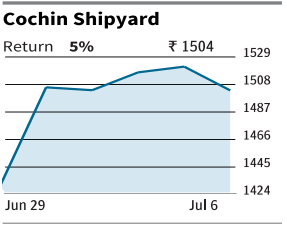
SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2686

ACROSS 1. Instruction 8. Emporium 9. Same 10. Idols 13. Emit 16. Oral 17. Soon 18. Moor 20. Derby 24. Need 25. Thankyou 26. Spoilsports

DOWN 2. Nape 3. Tired 4. Usual 5. Issue 6. Development 7. Sententious 11. Oread 12. Sever 14. Moot 15. Sago 19. Radio 21. Ethos 22. Banjo 23. Ryt

QUICKLY.

Govt launches stake sale in Cochin Shipyard today



The Centre will sell up to 5.04 per cent stake in Cochin Shipyard via an offer for sale, according to an X post from the Secretary of Department of Investment and Public Asset Management. The OFS consists of a base offer of 2.52 per cent equity stake in the state-run shipbuilder, with the option to sell an additional 2.52 per cent in case shares are oversubscribed. The government holds a 67.92 per cent stake in the company, as of March 31, according to exchange data. The floor price for the OFS has been fixed ₹1,400 per share — a discount of over 7 per cent to Cochin Shipyard's last closing price. The OFS will open for non-retail investors on July 7 and for retail investors on July 8.

Aastha Spintex ends a tad higher over IPO price

Bengaluru: Shares of Aastha Spintex settled flat after a weak debut on the stock exchanges on Monday, listing at ₹130 on the NSE and the BSE, a discount of 4.4 per cent to its IPO price of ₹136. The stock later closed a little over the offer price, at ₹136.49 and ₹136.45 on the NSE and BSE. The ₹170-crore initial public offering of the textile firm was subscribed 4.64 times. The portions reserved for NIIIs was subscribed 7.62 times, QIBs 3.30 times and retail investor category 2.33 times. Proceeds from the issue will be used towards part payment for the acquisition of Falcon Yarns Pvt Ltd, funding the working capital requirements of the acquired company and for general corporate purposes.

SEBI may double stocks eligible for borrowing

Reuters
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) aims to make it easier for investors to short stocks by nearly doubling the number of shares eligible for lending and borrowing and by cutting collateral requirements, two people with direct knowledge of the plans said. The changes are aimed at boosting the cash equities market and drawing investors away from derivatives market, which has seen explosive growth but carries far larger risks for retail investors in particular.

TIGHTER NORMS

Stock scandals led India to develop strict requirements for its cash equities market, with rules tightened in the early 2000s and then again in the period 2017 to 2020. That has meant that while

Laser Power & Infra fixes IPO price at ₹203-214 to raise ₹3,000 crore

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Laser Power & Infra has fixed a price band of ₹203 to ₹214 per equity share for its proposed initial public offering. The bidding for anchor investors will open on Wednesday and for others in investors on Thursday. Bids can be made for a minimum of 70 equity shares. The company will raise ₹3,000 crore from the IPO including ₹742 crore through the issuance of fresh equity shares. Laser Power & Infra plans to enhance R&D capabilities in power transmissions & distribution (T&D) as well as its EPC business. It intends to leverage in-house research and development capabilities to support the roll-out of new products. It also plans to enhance to further accelerate innovation through R&D capabilities to capitalise on emerging trends such as smart grid cabling, EV charging infrastructure, smart cables, in-

SBI Mutual Fund eyes private credit, unlisted equity through AIF

PATH CLEARED. RBI approval paves way for the SBI-owned fund house to tap \$25 billion private credit market

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

SBI Mutual Fund plans to enter into private credit and investment in unlisted equity space through the alternative investment fund. The fund house was operating in the private credit space but had to halt it after the RBI raised objections due to both the parent SBI and its subsidiary SBI MF operating in the same space. However, SBI MF has given its explanation, which has now been accepted by the RBI. **FUNDING GAP** Most large fund houses have been doing a roaring business in the private credit space by providing alternative debt financing to under-

served mid-market companies where traditional financing often faces limitations. The lending also supports job creation and drive product and market innovation. The IPO-bound fund house has all the required skill set ready and will venture into the private credit and unlisted space in next one-two months, said sources. SBI MF is also looking at the real estate space through the AIF but this will take some time, he added. Most fund houses operating in the private credit space through Category-II AIFs have delivered a return of 14-16 per cent. The minimum investment in this category is ₹1 crore. SBI MF also provides investment opportunity through



NEW PRODUCTS. The IPO bound SBI Mutual Fund has all the required skillsets ready and is expected to venture into private credit and unlisted space in one-two months

Specialised Investment Fund for sophisticated investors and has asset under management of ₹3,600 crore as of June-end. **GROWTH AVENUE** The venture into private credit and unlisted equity in-

PE, M&A deals jump thanks to mega cross-border transactions

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Mergers and acquisitions (M&A) and private equity (PE) dealmaking remained strong in the second quarter of 2026 despite heightened geopolitical tensions, with overall deal values more than doubling on the back of a handful of billion-dollar transactions, according to Grant Thornton Bharat's latest Dealtracker report. A total of 565 M&A and PE deals worth \$36.3 billion were announced during the quarter ended June, a 127 per cent increase in value since Q2 2022, when the HDFC-HDFC Bank merger

declined 18 per cent. "India's deal activity in Q2 2026 reflects a divergence between value and volume trends compared to Q1 2026. Deal volumes declined quarter-on-quarter, while total deal values increased to \$36.3 billion across 565 M&A and PE transactions, representing a 127 per cent increase over Q1 2026," Shanthi Vijetha, Partner, Due Diligence, Grant Thornton Bharat, said. M&A was the biggest contributor to the jump in deal values. The quarter saw 240 deals worth \$27.9 billion, the highest quarterly M&A value since Q2 2022, when the HDFC-HDFC Bank merger

Large deals in June quarter		
	Stake in	Size (\$ m)
Sun Pharma	Organon	11750
Bharti Airtel	Airtel Africa	2968
EPL	Indovidia	2000
Vinci Highways	Safeway	1600
GMR Group	GMR Airports	1050

Source: Grant Thornton

was announced. While M&A volumes declined 12 per cent sequentially, deal values surged 302 per cent, aided by five out-bound billion-dollar acquisitions. The biggest transaction during the quarter was Sun Pharmaceutical Industries' \$11.75-billion acquisition of Organon & Co, the largest

Banking, realty stocks help in Sensex, Nifty gains

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru

The benchmarks ended higher for the fourth straight day on Monday, led by strong buying in blue-chip banking, realty and defence counters amid subdued crude oil prices, easing geopolitical tensions and growing expectations of a less hawkish stance from the US Federal Reserve. "The calmness in the West Asia region and hopes for a relatively steady corporate earnings season kept investor mood optimistic, although overall sentiment remains cautious," Ankur Punj, MD & Business Head, Equirus Wealth, said. The BSE Sensex rose 521.16 points to close at 78,285.0. The NSE Nifty 50 gained 159.50 points to settle at 24,430.35. Both the Nifty Midcap 100 and the Nifty Smallcap 100 also gained about 0.4 per cent. However, the market breadth remained neutral.

DEFENCE STOCKS JUMP Defence stocks outperformed after the Defence Acquisition Council approved capital acquisition proposals worth ₹52,000 crore. Zen Technologies, Dynamatic Technologies, Paras Defence and Data Patterns outperformed. Abhinav Tiwari, Research Analyst at Bonanza, said management commentary, future guidance, crude oil prices, foreign investor flows and global interest rate expectations are likely to drive market direction. He added that until earnings provide greater clarity, stock-specific movements are expected to dominate.

SHIFT IN PE DEAL PE activity moderated during the quarter, with 325 deals worth \$8.4 billion, down 22 per cent in volume and 8 per cent in value from the previous quarter. However, average deal size increased to \$25.8 million from \$21.8 million, reflecting a shift towards fewer but larger transactions. The quarter also saw the emergence of four new unicorns, such as Skyroot Aerospace, Square Yards Consulting, Sarvam AI and KreditBee.

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

SOBHA (BUY) Target: ₹1,775 CMP: ₹1,457.35 Sobha reported Q1FY27 booking value of ₹3,660 crore, 41 per cent above our estimate of ₹2,600 crore. Pre-sales came in well ahead of the company's highest prior quarterly run-rate, driven by strong response to new launches. Sales area for the quarter stood at 2.3 million sq ft, with 1,432 homes and plots sold, while average price realisation improved to ₹15,655 per sq ft. Bengaluru delivered its strongest-ever quarterly sales at ₹2,067 crore (56.5 per cent of total sales), followed by NCR at ₹1,384 crore (37.9 per cent). The company launched three new projects during the quarter with combined saleable area of 6.9 million sq ft across Bengaluru and Gurugram. SOBHA Crescent, Phase 1 of a 12-acre luxury residential development in Sector 63A, Gurugram, comprises 336 homes across 0.9 million sq ft with an estimated sales potential of ₹2,200 crore. In Bengaluru, the company launched Sobha OneWorld – a 47.4-acre luxury residential project in Hoskote, comprising 3,484 homes across 5.4 million sq ft with an estimated sales potential of over ₹7,500 crore; the initial phase comprises 2,249 homes across 3.4 million sq ft. Lastly, it also launched a DM project – Sacred Grove by the Lake – a 26-acre premium plotted development in Chikka Tirupathi, Bengaluru, offering 388 plots across 0.6 million sq ft. The company completed 671 homes across eight projects during the quarter, totalling 1.1 million sq ft of saleable area.

CD Research

VINATI ORGANICS (ACCUMULATE) Target: ₹1,552 CMP: ₹1,342.15 Despite stable growth of its major revenue contributor, ATBS, overall Vinati Organics' revenue from operations fell to ₹603.92 crore in Q4FY26 from ₹648.46 crore in Q4FY25, down 6.9 per cent. With growing applications of high-purity ATBS in water treatment, mining, detergents, etc. Vinati Organics (VOL) completed its capacity expansion of ATBS from 40,000 mt to 50,000 mt in FY26. The company plans to ramp up production of ATBS, but susceptibility of demand continues to cast shadow on ATBS throughput. Operating margin inched up to 28.2 per cent in Q4FY26. In spite of 150 bps increase in net profit margins – as a result of effectively passing on both raw material and logistics cost fluctuations – net profits remained nearly flat at ₹123.86 crore in Q4FY26. The company foresees antioxidants to become a bigger revenue contributor in future. The stock currently trades at 30.1x FY27e EPS of ₹43.14 and 25.1x FY28e EPS of ₹51.73. We expect VOL to have an operating margin in the range of 27-28 per cent as a result of improving margins in ATBS and ramping up in production of antioxidants. The company is spending on R&D to introduce new products in its subsidiary Veeral Organics, which is expected to generate meaningful sales. These measures will aid in revenue growing at a CAGR of 12.5 per cent over the next two years. Weighing odds, we assign 'accumulate' rating on the stock with target price of ₹1,552, based on 30x FY28e EPS.

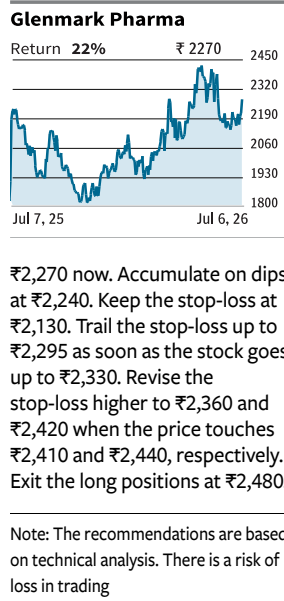
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TODAY'S PICK.

Glenmark Pharmaceuticals (₹2,270.45): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for Glenmark Pharmaceuticals. The stock has formed a good base above ₹2,150. The recent rise is also occurring on strong trendline support. Both these factors indicate that the corrective fall has ended and a new leg of the upmove has begun. A cluster of supports is there in the ₹2,220-₹2,180 region. Fresh buyers can enter the market around this support zone to limit downside. Glenmark Pharmaceuticals' share price can rise to ₹2,500 in the coming week. Traders can buy Glenmark Pharmaceuticals shares at



Day trading guide

24480 >> Nifty 50 Futures					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
24400	24350	24520	24680	Go long on a break above 24520. Keep the stop-loss at 24490	

₹828 >> HDFC Bank					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
820	813	832	838	Go long only above 832. Stop-loss can be kept at 830	

₹1044 >> Infosys					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1030	1010	1060	1085	Take fresh shorts below 1030 with a stop-loss at 1035	

₹289 >> ITC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
287	285	291	293	Can go either way from here. Avoid trading this stock	

₹244 >> ONGC					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
241	238	248	252	Go long now and at 242. Keep the stop-loss at 240	

₹1321 >> Reliance Ind.					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1310	1290	1325	1350	Go long on a break above 1325 with a stop-loss at 1320	

₹1038 >> SBI					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
1030	1020	1050	1070	Take fresh longs above 1050. Keep the stop-loss at 1045	

₹2059 >> TCS					
S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT	
2045	2000	2075	2110	Go long only on break above 2075. Keep the stop-loss at 2060	

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 159.50 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
HDFC Bank	829.85	96.32	16.13	11.36	
Reliance Ind	1321.30	25.53	18.67	7.98	
ICIJ Bank	1426.90	24.25	17.67	9.14	
M&M	3201.20	12.54	21.38	2.56	
Bharti Airtel	1925.70	10.16	34.69	5.24	
Hindalco	980.40	8.60	16.45	1.27	
Bajaj Auto	10036.50	6.07	26.53	0.99	
Bharat Elec	425.55	5.87	51.31	1.36	
ONGC	249.90	5.14	6.16	0.85	
Eicher Motors	7471.50	3.97	37.19	0.92	
L&T	4041.00	3.68	29.33	4.23	
Eternal Ltd.	283.40	2.76	747.24	1.83	
JSW Steel	1243.20	2.66	11.92	1.04	
Grasim Ind	3213.00	2.65	21.23	1.08	
Maruti Suzuki	14456.00	2.56	30.96	1.69	
Nestle India	1473.70	2.18	81.21	0.94	
Titan	4864.40	2.10	78.46	1.66	
Tata Steel	190.87	1.93	21.89	1.41	
Sun Pharma	1912.80	1.85	39.88	1.81	
Cipla	1472.30	1.73	30.80	0.74	
Asian Paints	2754.90	1.69	60.13	1.11	
Tata Motors	347.05	1.35	4260.42	0.65	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	240.00	0.47	101.53	0.70	
Trent Ltd.	3343.80	0.23	103.59	0.99	
TataConsumerProduct	1117.90	0.17	71.52	0.65	
Hind Unilever	2202.00	0.16	48.89	0.75	
SBI Life	1787.70	-0.10	72.60	1.72	
Apollo Hosp	8888.50	-0.11	63.82	0.82	
NTPC	356.25	-0.21	12.54	1.51	
Adani Enter	3206.00	-0.35	41.92	0.83	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1062.30	-0.40	24.93	1.33	
Tech Mahindra	1406.50	-0.50	28.68	0.80	
HDFC Life	564.20	-0.82	63.67	0.54	
Dr Reddys Lab	1367.90	-0.83	27.46	0.75	
Int'l Globeavi	5408.50	-0.89	0.00	1.09	
Wipro	174.32	-1.10	13.80	0.45	
HCL Tech	1134.20	-1.11	18.48	1.07	
Bajaj Finance	1029.10	-1.35	33.14	2.47	
Axis Bank	1339.60	-1.57	15.69	3.44	
Adani Ports	1864.40	-1.58	33.61	1.23	
UltraTech Cement	11661.00	-1.60	41.97	1.23	
State Bank	1427.30	-2.08	11.05	3.83	
PowerGrid Corp	285.40	-2.42	16.66	1.16	
Bajaj Finserve	1870.70	-3.15	15.22	0.97	
Coal India	432.35	-3.32	8.58	0.93	
Max Healthcare	1132.50	-3.40	76.41	0.75	
ITC	288.25	-3.58	17.18	2.48	
Infyosys	1042.20	-3.83	14.35	3.27	
TCS	2957.60	-8.81	15.05	1.88	
Kotak Bank	381.30	-24.84	19.66	2.51	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 416.65 pts.
	Close(t)	Pts	PE	WN(t)	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1850.50	76.96	30.15	3.23	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	925.05	65.31	121.74	2.56	
Ivs Motor Cmp	3705.00	53.42	55.24	3.51	
Adani Energy Solutions	1822.80	51.97	81.47	2.15	
Cummins India	5578.50	39.79	65.48	3.04	
Divis Lab	6857.50	37.43	70.89	3.51	
Siemens Energy India	3420.30	35.98	92.99	1.22	
Avenueesuper	4064.70	33.20	89.27	2.64	
Macrotech Developers	1095.90	31.63	31.91	1.23	
United Spirits	1427.30	29.44	55.61	1.70	
Godrej Consumer	1100.60	27.91	60.50	1.78	
Britannia Ind	5454.50	26.06	51.79	2.59	
Muthootfin	3137.60	25.99	11.88	1.36	
Indian Hotels Co.	738.15	24.58	46.76	2.61	
Abb India	7073.00	18.84	94.85	1.50	
Pitlindint	1616.90	17.16	66.61	2.02	
Torontor Pharma	4822.70	16.73	76.34	2.04	
Tata Power	377.55	11.49	23.57	2.54	
Siemens	3571.60	9.15	82.98	1.27	
Vedanta	282.00	7.95	6.95	1.93	
Gail (India)	1750.3	6.96	15.18	1.90	
Magazgon Dock	2573.90	6.75	37.68	0.79	
Hindustanaironautics	4440.60	6.50	32.58	3.40	
Jindal Steel	1059.50	5.97	32.16	1.58	
Bosch	42125.00	5.85	55.55	1.40	
Hindus Zinc	540.35	5.36	16.51	1.05	
Zyduslifesiences	1147.90	5.35	22.54	1.16	
Hyundai Motor India	2004.40	4.60	29.99	1.15	
Solar Industries	18539.00	1.78	96.60	1.82	
Indian Oilcorp	141.68	1.31	4.58	1.87	
Tata Capital	350.15	1.11	30.39	0.71	
Bpcl	308.15	0.00	5.17	2.52	
Rural Elec	364.75	-1.46	5.89	1.84	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	90.24	-1.95	16.83	0.73	
Ambuja Cements	441.40	-3.65	19.96	1.11	
DF	673.30	-4.89	37.75	1.74	
Shree Cement	26630.00	-5.29	54.95	1.44	
Adanigreenenergy	1549.20	-6.88	128.43	2.09	
Canara Bank	126.46	-7.19	6.42	1.71	
Ltintindtree	3727.50	-8.25	22.19	1.40	
Punjab Natl Bank	104.29	-10.70	6.49	1.45	
Union Bank	161.08	-11.38	3.33	1.25	
Bank Of Baroda	249.95	-12.23	6.44	1.87	
Samvardmotherinternatl	145.33	-12.56	37.54	2.59	
Tata Motors Cv	429.90	-12.85	52.28	3.62	
Hdfc Amc	2773.40	-16.01	41.60	2.28	
Power Finance	421.10	-20.06	4.13	2.47	
Adani Power	219.85	-23.59	32.99	3.68	
Uthmaniyah	100.00	-29.59	12.30	0.80	
Varun Beverages	494.85	-83.95	52.15	2.73	

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Nikhil Kamath's WTF acquires BTG Studios



Bengaluru: BTG Studios (By The Gram), a Mumbai-based independent creative agency, founded by Aaliya Amrin, Eman Batliwalla and Danisha Kohli, has been acquired by WTF, a media and venture platform founded by Nikhil Kamath (*in picture*). The acquisition marks WTF's second in an independent creative agency following One Hand Clap (OHC). Under the partnership's terms, BTG's founders and existing team retain full operational and creative control of the agency. The acquisition provides BTG with capital, access to WTF's network and distribution infrastructure and improve its reach. Founded in 2018, the agency has previously worked with Netflix, Prime Video, IKEA, Volkswagen, Bumble and Soho House across luxury, beauty, hospitality, entertainment, technology, tourism, wellness, lifestyle and consumer sectors. **OUR BUREAU**

Waiting period for electric 2Ws crosses one month, says FADA

PLAN B. President of dealers' body says rise in demand shows a broader shift towards alternative powertrains

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India's electric two-wheeler market is beginning to face supply constraints as demand accelerates with waiting periods stretching beyond a month across several brands and manufacturers scrambling to expand production, according to the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA).

LOSING MARKET SHARE
The dealers' body said the surge in EV demand reflects a broader shift in consumer preference towards alternative powertrains even as conventional petrol and diesel vehicles steadily lose market share.

Speaking to *businessline*, FADA President CS Vigneshwar said dealerships are witnessing a sharp rise in bookings for electric two-wheelers, with waiting periods varying by brand and region.

At his dealership, bookings stretched to nearly two

Dealers have not observed widespread evidence that ethanol-related concerns are changing purchase decisions

CS VIGNESHWAR
FADA President



months, while Hero, TVS and Bajaj were seeing waiting periods as they struggle to match demand. "Capacity has to be increased. Availability of batteries and chips could also become a challenge because much of the supply chain is still dependent on imports," he said.

He added that manufacturers would have to scale production as EV demand continues to rise.

The demand surge is expected to gather further momentum as States roll out new EV policies and incentives, while the Centre continues to support electric mobility through schemes

such as PM E-DRIVE. The strong demand for EVs comes as India's passenger vehicle market undergoes its biggest fuel transition in decades.

FADA's June retail data showed CNG, hybrid and electric vehicles together accounted for 40.35 per cent of passenger vehicle registrations, the first time alternative powertrains have crossed the 40 per cent mark. Petrol vehicles accounted for 43.63 per cent of registrations, while diesel's share fell to 16.02 per cent.

"Ten years ago nearly 95 percent of the market was petrol and diesel. Today, al-

ternative powertrains have reached around 40 per cent. At this pace, CNG, hybrids and EVs together should account for more than 50 per cent of passenger vehicle sales within the next two to three years," he said.

The June fuel mix points to a clear shift away from conventional fuels. Petrol's share of passenger vehicle registrations declined to 43.63 per cent from 47.68 per cent in June 2025, a drop of 4.05 percentage points, the sharpest decline among all fuel types. Diesel also continued its gradual slide, falling to 16.02 per cent from 18.74 per cent, a decline of 2.72 percentage points.

Together, petrol and diesel accounted for 59.65 per cent of passenger vehicle registrations, down from 66.42 per cent a year earlier, highlighting the rapid diversification of India's passenger vehicle market.

BIGGEST WINNER

While EVs continue to dominate headlines, CNG has quietly been the biggest gainer over the past year.

CNG's share of passenger vehicle registrations increased to 24.33 per cent from 20.82 per cent, a gain of 3.51 percentage points, exceeding the 2.95 percentage-point increase in EVs, whose share rose to 7.75 per cent from 4.80 per cent.

Hybrid vehicles also strengthened, increasing to 8.27 per cent from 7.97 per cent. The data indicate that India's transition is being driven by multiple technologies, rather than electrification alone.

The decline in petrol's market share has coincided with growing public debate around E20 petrol. However, Vigneshwar said dealers have not observed widespread evidence that ethanol-related concerns are changing customer purchase decisions. According to him, most customers continue to rely on assurances from automakers and the government that E20-compatible vehicles are safe, while EV-buying decisions are being driven primarily by lower running costs and a wider range of products.

Fresh supplier dispute lands Ola Electric before NCLT

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Electric two-wheeler maker Ola Electric is facing fresh insolvency proceedings after two of its component suppliers moved the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) alleging payment defaults of around ₹40 crore.

In separate petitions filed under Section 9 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), 2016, Sterling E-Mobility Solutions Ltd, the EV components arm of listed Sterling Tools Ltd, and Anevolve Mando eMobility Pvt Ltd, part of the Anand Group, have sought the initiation of the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) against Ola Electric Technologies Pvt Ltd, the company's wholly owned subsidiary.

POOR STANDARDS

Sources close to the development described the matter as a commercial dispute, saying Ola Electric had earlier initiated legal proceedings against the suppliers, alleging that the components supplied did not meet the agreed standards.

"We have filed a suit stating that the quality has not been met. We filed our case first, following which the

vendors moved under the IBC," said a person familiar with the matter.

LEGAL DISPUTES

The development marks the latest legal dispute between Ola Electric and its vendors. In March last year, Rosmerta Digital Services Ltd had also filed an insolvency petition before the Bengaluru bench of the NCLT, alleging payment defaults for services rendered to Ola Electric Technologies.

That dispute was subsequently resolved between the parties, and the petition was withdrawn.

The latest petitions come at a time when Ola Electric has reported improved operating performance. According to Vahan registration data cited by the company, registrations nearly doubled sequentially to 43,719 vehicles in the April-June quarter of FY27, up from 22,252 in the preceding quarter.

The company also narrowed its consolidated net loss by 42 per cent to ₹500 crore in the March quarter (Q4FY26) from ₹870 crore a year earlier. The improvement, however, came alongside lower revenue and vehicle volumes, which the company had described as part of a "year of reset".

With new Evervan Kothari plant set to add capacity, Adidas expands India sourcing

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

German sportswear giant Adidas is steadily expanding its manufacturing footprint in India, reinforcing the country's role in its global footwear supply chain. Vietnam and Indonesia, however, continue to dominate its sourcing network, according to its January 2026 global supplier list.

KARUR PLANT

With the Evervan Kothari footwear plant set to be commissioned in Karur in Tamil Nadu on July 10, Adidas is expanding its India sourcing. Industry sources estimate that India currently accounts for 5-10 per cent of the company's footwear sourcing.

Adidas' latest supplier list shows that India has 14 supplier facilities, employing around 22,600 workers led by Apache Footwear in Tirupati.

The Karur plant, a joint venture between Evervan Group and Kothari Industrial Corporation, will have an annual capacity of 40 million pairs and create around 15,000 jobs, signalling Adidas' growing confidence in India as a global footwear manufacturing base. Rafiq



A LEG-UP. Adidas' latest supplier list shows that India has 14 supplier facilities, employing around 22,600 workers, led by Apache Footwear in Tirupati **BUJOY GHOSH**

Industry sources estimate that India currently accounts for 5-10% of the company's footwear sourcing

Ahmed, Vice-Chairman of Kothari Industrial Corporation Ltd, said that Adidas has built one of the world's most diversified manufacturing networks across China, Vietnam, Indonesia and Cambodia. "As the company expands its presence in India,

it is natural to broaden its supplier base as global footwear brands typically do not rely on a single manufacturing partner," he said.

The Karur facility will manufacture fashion sneakers with textile uppers for global markets.

HWASEUNG DEAL

Meanwhile, South Korean footwear manufacturer Hwaseung, another global supplier to Adidas, is also planning to manufacture Adidas shoes in India. The company had signed a memorandum of understanding with the Tamil

Nadu government in August 2025 to establish a ₹1,720-crore non-leather footwear facility in Tirunelveli with the potential to create 20,000 jobs. However, it subsequently shifted the project to neighbouring Andhra Pradesh's Chittoor district with a revised investment of ₹893 crore.

In its 2025 annual report, Adidas said it sourced nearly 400 million pairs of footwear globally.

LARGEST SOURCE

Vietnam remained the largest sourcing country, accounting for 27 per cent of total footwear volumes, followed by Indonesia at 18 per cent and China at 16 per cent. The remaining 39 per cent was sourced from other manufacturing locations, including India. Overall, Asia accounted for 92 per cent of Adidas' global footwear production last year.

According to Adidas supplier list, India's supplier ecosystem is anchored by Apache Footwear's facilities in Andhra Pradesh, which employ nearly 11,000 workers. Uttarakhand has emerged as another key manufacturing hub with facilities operated by Mochiko Shoes Pvt Ltd, SSA Footwear Pvt Ltd and associated subcontractors.

Space crunch drives brands to mall kiosks

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

Finding space in India's leading malls has become almost as challenging as attracting customers.

With premium retail space in short supply, beauty, fashion and digitally native brands are increasingly turning to kiosks as a lower-risk entry point, allowing them to test demand, validate locations and build brand visibility before committing to full-fledged stores.

From beauty and fashion labels to digitally native D2C brands and premium food and beverage players, companies are increasingly opting for compact kiosks to test consumer demand, validate locations and build brand visibility. What was once viewed as temporary retail is now evolving into a strategic entry point to organised malls, particularly when quality retail space becomes difficult to secure.

REDUCES RISKS

Blackstone-backed Nexus Select Trust, which operates 19 malls across 15 cities, says the format allows both brands and mall operators to reduce risk before making long-term commitments. "We give them kiosks and ask them to spend 11 months understanding the market. During that time, we also



GAINING TRUST. Kiosks allow brands to test demand and build brand visibility before committing to full-fledged stores

evaluate how they perform. If the concept works, we can then offer them a larger store," said Pratik Dantara, Chief Investor Relations Officer and Head of Strategy at Nexus Select Trust.

The staged approach has become increasingly relevant as established malls operate at high occupancy levels. Rather than allocating large stores to relatively untested brands, mall operators are using kiosks as a screening mechanism, while brands gain access to premium locations at a fraction of the investment required for a permanent outlet.

Industry experts say the shift also reflects the growing maturity of India's omnichannel retail landscape.

According to Anuj Kejriwal, CEO, Retail, Europe, Middle East & Africa at Anarock Group, D2C brands accounted for more than 25 per cent of retail leasing in 2025. Kiosks, he said, have

become valuable omnichannel touchpoints, allowing brands to gauge customer response before committing to larger expansion plans.

For brands, the economics is equally compelling. Setting up a kiosk requires significantly lower capital while providing the crucial "touch-and-feel" experience that online-first businesses often lack.

The smaller format also offers the flexibility to experiment with locations, merchandise and consumer preferences without taking on the financial risk of a conventional store.

Sunil Munshi, COO, Retail at Brigade Group, said interest is particularly strong from digitally native brands, lifestyle companies and premium food and beverage players.

The model works because it combines cost efficiency with customer engagement, flexibility and immediate access to high-footfall destinations.

As brands gain confidence through kiosks, many eventually aspire to larger stores. But in premium malls, space availability, not just affordability, has become the biggest hurdle. Kiosks, therefore, strike a balance, allowing brands to establish a physical presence while giving mall operators time to assess whether the concept complements the mall's positioning and tenant mix before allocating permanent space.

The model is also helping mall operators diversify their retail mix without taking unnecessary leasing risks. If a brand performs well, it can graduate to a larger format. If not, operators avoid the disruption of replacing a full-sized tenant.

Kiosks are no longer viewed merely as a stepping stone. Kejriwal noted that they are increasingly becoming permanent fixtures within retailers' omnichannel strategies, offering flexible, hyper-local touchpoints even as brands plan larger flagship stores in key markets.

In Mumbai, Bengaluru and the NCR, premium and international brands are using kiosks in high-footfall zones, where retail space commands a premium. In tier-2 cities, the format enables brands to test demand before investing in full-scale stores in new malls.

'Data, not guesswork, determines guaranteed future value for our cars'

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

BMW says data, not guesswork, drives the guaranteed future value (GFV) of its vehicles, with the luxury carmaker relying on global residual-value models, quarterly market updates and customer driving patterns to forecast the resale values for both internal combustion engine (ICE) and electric vehicles.

BMW Group India President and CEO Hardeep Singh Brar said the company does not charge an additional financing premium for electric vehicles under its GFV programmes despite India's still-evolving used-EV market, arguing that its data-driven approach provides sufficient confidence in future residual values.

As more automakers launch GFV-backed ownership programmes, Brar said the model is evolving beyond a financing tool into a mechanism that

offers customers greater ownership flexibility, while helping create an organised premium used-EV market as the first wave of buyback vehicles returns later this decade.

Edited excerpts:

Guaranteed Future Value sits at the heart of products such as BMW 360°. How does BMW decide what a vehicle will be worth three or four years from now?
Our residual value model for both electric and internal combustion engine vehicles is based on a global statistical model.

It draws inputs from multiple sources, including used-car market pricing, customer usage patterns and product developments such as battery improvements and higher driving ranges in EVs.

These inputs are refreshed every quarter, allowing us to continuously refine our residual value assumptions as markets and technologies evolve.

Electric vehicles are evolving rapidly, and

India still has a relatively young used-EV market. How do you underwrite that residual value risk?

One of the biggest advantages we have is our own customer data.

We have analysed more than 25 million km of driving data in India, and what surprised us is how similar the usage patterns of EV and ICE customers actually are.

For example, the BMW iX1 is driven about 10,737 km annually compared with around 9,400 km for the X1. Similarly, the i7 averages 7,289 km against 7,332 km for the 7 Series.

Despite the evolving EV landscape, we don't levy any additional interest rate premium to compensate for residual-value risk.

That is a conscious decision because we want to accelerate EV adoption while helping India's used-EV market mature.

Most structured ownership products depend on customers returning the vehicles in a predictable condition. How does BMW manage

We have analysed more than 25 million km of driving data in India, and what surprised us is how similar the usage patterns of EV and ICE customers actually are

HARDEEP SINGH BRAR
BMW India President and CEO

mileage limits, vehicle-condition assessments and end-of-term risk?

Customers generally choose plans that match their driving patterns, and we offer multiple usage options.

Cases of significant mileage breaches are relatively few. Where charges apply, they are disclosed clearly at the beginning of the contract and remain broadly in line with industry norms.

Vehicle-return assessments follow standard wear-and-tear guidelines communicated to customers at the start of the contract.



The inspection is conducted through a structured process by trained dealer teams, with a multi-level escalation mechanism if customers disagree with the assessment.

Every customer also receives an end-of-term survey, and that feedback is reviewed by management to improve the process continuously.

At maturity, customers can return the vehicle, refinance the residual amount or retain the vehicle by paying the balloon amount.

The product is designed to provide multiple exit op-

tions while keeping default risks well contained because the underlying asset retains strong value.

GFV is moving from luxury to premium end of the passenger car market with Audi, Tata Motors and MG now offering GFV products. How does BMW differentiate its proposition?

More brands entering the GFV space validates the category. However, the products are fundamentally different. BMW 360° is backed by BMW Financial Services and our captive finance ecosystem, whereas several newer offerings in the market are insurance-based residual-value products.

The difference lies in how the risk is managed, how commitments are honoured and the overall ownership ecosystem supporting the customer.

BMW 360° competes on the strength of the complete ownership experience, rather than simply offering the highest guaranteed residual value.

BMW and Mini vehicles also enjoy strong resale values in the open market, which reinforces the proposition.

The first large wave of BMW iX1s sold under BMW 360° will begin returning only towards the end of the decade. How is BMW preparing for that transition?

BMW Premium Selection, our certified pre-owned business, has been expanding steadily.

At the same time, we are seeing growing customer acceptance of used electric vehicles, and our dealer network is being trained specifically to support pre-owned EV buyers.

iX1 carries the largest volume of assured buyback contracts, and since most customers have opted for four-year plans, the bulk of those vehicles will start returning from 2029 onwards.

We see that as an opportunity rather than a challenge as it will help deepen India's organised premium used-EV market and create a natural upgrade cycle for customers.

NCLT approves merger of Torrent Pharma, JB Chemicals

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) has approved the merger of JB Chemicals & Pharmaceuticals Ltd with Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd, clearing a key regulatory hurdle for one of the largest consolidation deals in India's pharmaceutical sector. In separate regulatory filings on Monday, both companies said NCLT had sanctioned the scheme of amalgamation under Sections 230 to 232 of the Companies Act.

SHAREHOLDERS' NOD

The merger will become effective after the certified copy of the tribunal's order is filed with the Registrar of Companies (RoC), following which the companies will announce the effective date.

The approval follows shareholders of both companies voting in favour of the scheme at NCLT-convened meetings held in April this year.

QUICKLY.

Dollar strength pulls gold off two-week high

Gold prices retreated from a two-week high on Monday, pressured by a firmer US dollar, though losses were limited as signs of a cooling US labour market eased expectations of a Federal Reserve rate hike. Spot gold fell 1 per cent to \$4,141.69 per ounce by 08:59 am ET (1258 GMT) after hitting its highest since June 22. US gold futures for August delivery climbed 0.7 per cent to \$4,154.00 per ounce. **REUTERS**

Aluminium climbs on West Asia supply concerns

Aluminium prices rose on Monday as focus returned to forecasts of shortages created by disruptions to supplies from West Asia and dwindling stocks. Benchmark aluminium on the London Metal Exchange traded 0.7 per cent higher at \$3,112 a tonne in official rings. It hit \$3,040, the lowest since February 19, as peace talks between the US and Iran fuelled optimism for a resumption of supplies from West Asia. **REUTERS**

Paddy acreage sees major recovery on 35% surplus rain during July 1-5

SOWING WOES. However, overall area is down 21% as coarse cereals, pulses and oilseeds’ acreage trails

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Aided by a 35 per cent surplus of rain in the first five days of this month, the coverage of the kharif season’s main cereal, paddy, narrowed its deficit to 13 per cent as of July 5 against a shortfall of 25 per cent until June 25.

However, the overall acreage of all crops was still lower by 21 per cent against the 23 per cent gap as of June 25.

COVERAGE GAP

According to data, the acreage reached 350.85 lakh hectares (lh) as of July 5, which is 32 per cent of the season’s normal area of 1,104.46 lh and 21 per cent less compared with 442.80 lh in the year-ago period.

After the revival of the monsoon from July 1, the

overall deficiency, which was 39 per cent in June, has now been reported at 20 per cent during June 1-6, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) data show.

As central India and the North-West region have received good rain in the past few days, experts said sowing activities will get a boost, and more coverage is expected in the next week.

COTTON 23% LOWER

The kharif season’s main cereal paddy has been transplanted on 60.24 lh against 69.30 lh a year ago, while pulses acreage reached 37.15 lh against 47.49 lh and that of oilseeds at 66.31 lh against 109.27 lh.

The coverage of nutri/coarse cereals was reported 16 per cent lower at 60.12 lh against 71.86 lh.

Cotton acreage is 23 per cent lower at 63.18 lh from 82 lh, while soybean is down

Kharif sowing*		(lakh hectare)	
	2025	2026	% Change
Paddy	69.30	60.24	-13.1
Pulses	47.49	37.15	-21.8
Arhar	21.00	12.35	-41.2
Urdbean	4.63	3.01	-35.0
Moongbean	17.20	16.81	-2.3
Shri Anna cum Coarse cereals	71.86	60.12	-16.3
Jowar	4.89	4.53	-7.4
Bajra	30.00	20.82	-30.6
Ragi	0.88	0.84	-4.5
Maize	35.00	32.94	-5.9
Oilseeds	109.27	66.31	-39.3
Groundnut	28.00	16.93	-39.5
Soybean	79.20	47.80	-39.6
Cotton	82.00	63.18	-23.0
Sugarcane	56.72	57.58	1.5
All Crops	442.80	350.85	-20.8

*As of July 5; Source: Agriculture Ministry

to 47.80 lh from 79.20 lh, and groundnut to 16.93 lh from 28 lh.

Among pulses, arhar (pigeon peas) sowing reached 12.35 lh, down from 21 lh,

moong (green gram) 16.81 lh from 17.20 lh and urad (black matpe) at 3.01 lh from 4.63 lh. Among the coarse/nutri cereals, jowar area reached 4.53 lh against 4.89 lh a year ago, whereas bajra dipped to 20.82 lh from 30 lh, ragi at 0.84 lh from 0.88 lh and maize at 32.94 lh from 35 lh.

Sugarcane acreage has reached 57.58 lh against 56.72 lh a year ago, while jute and mesta coverage were reported at 6.28 lh from 6.16 lh, data show.

CROP TARGETS

The government has fixed a production target of 176.16 million tonnes (mt) of foodgrains, which includes 123.15 mt of rice, 8.4 mt of pulses, 31.04 mt of maize and 13.56 mt of nutri cereals during Kharif 2026.

As part of the 28.92 mt oilseeds target, the aim for soyabean is 14.85 mt and groundnut 11.35 mt.

Central banks bought net 41 tonnes of gold in May

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Central banks bought a net 41 tonnes of gold in May, with Poland, China, Uzbekistan and Kazakhstan making significant purchases in the month.

“Central banks were back in buying mode in May — and with a little more spring in their step... Purchases once again concentrated among a familiar cast of buyers,” said Marissa Salim, Senior Research Lead, APAC of the World Gold Council (WGC).

Poland purchased 18 tonnes, China 10 tonnes, Uzbekistan 9 tonnes and Kazakhstan 7 tonnes. Singapore rejoined the list of buyers, reporting a net purchase of 4 tonnes, its first monthly net purchase since September 2025.

Year-to-date, Poland has purchased 64 tonnes of gold, followed by Uzbekistan and China at 33 tonnes and 25 tonnes, respectively. Kazakhstan has accumulated 20 tonnes year-to-date.

SELLING SPREE

Turkey sold 3 tonnes and Russia 6 tonnes, continuing their sell-off spree witnessed since the Iran war broke out on February 28. Year-to-date, Turkey has sold 81 tonnes and Russia 34 tonnes.

The Central Bank of Republic of Turkey’s sales of gold are policy-driven and tactical to manage the balance of payment rather than a shift in strategy. The bank sells gold for forex operations to defend its currency lira and for gold-for-currency swap futures to secure immediate liquidity.

Russian sales are to manage budget deficits and soaring military expenditures. Moscow has been drawing down its war chest to manage domestic spending and convert assets into currencies like the Chinese yuan.

Poland has also said it



would sell gold for managing defence expenditure. However, for the fourth month in a row, it purchased the yellow metal. It was a three-month high. Poland now holds 614 tonnes of gold in its reserves, inching closer to its 700 tonnes target, said Salim.

CHINA’S BUY

The People’s Bank of China continued to be a net purchaser for the 20th consecutive month. The 10 tonnes purchased in May was its highest 17 months. China has added 25 tonnes to its reserves and is among the top three accumulators this year.

“China’s official gold reserves now stand at 9 per cent of total reserves or around 2,331 tonnes,” said Salim.

Singapore, with its latest purchase, has increased its holdings to 197 tonnes. The Monetary Authority of Singapore is looking to establish central bank gold vaulting services from October 2026, in line with the country’s plans to establish a gold hub in the city state.

Among other buyers were the Czech National Bank and the Central Bank of Jordan, which bought 2 tonnes and 1 tonne, respectively. The Czech bank has been a net buyer for 39 months now.

Barring March, central banks across the world have been buying gold. Their purchases of the yellow metal was one of the reasons for the dazzling rally since January 2024, which peaked on January 29 this year at \$5,608 an ounce.

Monsoon recovers across India, but North-East still awaits rain

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

The monsoon continues to build on a comeback after days of sustained, widespread rainfall erased much of the season’s early shortfall. The worst-affected regions, central India and the South Peninsula, are back to a 14 per cent deficit each, well within the India Meteorological Department’s ‘normal rainfall’ range of -19 to +19 per cent.

The recovery is set to broaden as the monsoon pushes into the North-West this week, where the deficit narrowed to 22 per cent on Monday. East and North-

East India remain the lone laggards, with rainfall still 42 per cent below normal. But the region’s towering climatological rainfall benchmark, shaped by the Himalayas and the moisture-rich Bay of Bengal, means even substantial rain often leaves it looking more deficient than the rest of the country.

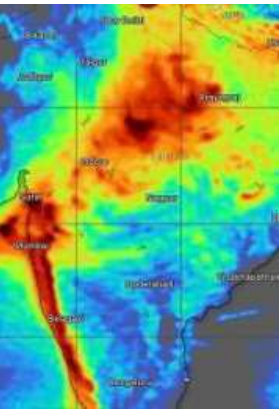
SYSTEM STALLS AGAIN?

The monsoon, however, seemed to have stalled once again on Monday, delaying the final phase of its advance across the country. Its northern limit passed through Jamnagar, Udaipur, Ajmer, Jhunjhunu, Hisar and Bathinda for the third successive day, according to the

IMD. The conditions are favourable for it to advance into Gujarat, the remaining areas of Haryana and Punjab, and Rajasthan over the next three days. It normally covers the entire country by July 8. This year, it is likely to be delayed by a few days.

MORE HEAVY RAIN

There is no let-up for parts of the already soaked West and Central India. The IMD predicted heavy to very heavy rain with extremely heavy rainfall over Konkan and Gujarat for another day on Tuesday and over Madhya Maharashtra on Tuesday and Wednesday. Heavy to very heavy rainfall with extremely heavy rainfall, is likely over



The heavy rain belt has shifted towards the Himalayan foothills, sparing Central India

coastal Karnataka on these days. Meanwhile, the depression that crossed the Odisha

coast moved inland and was centred on Monday about 60 km north-northeast of Rourkela. It is expected to track north-west across Jharkhand, north Chhattisgarh and adjoining east Madhya Pradesh until Tuesday, sustaining widespread rain over the region.

The seasonal trough across North-West India, the principal rain-bearing axis that channels moisture from the Bay into the interior, extended on Monday from south-west Rajasthan to the east-central Bay, passing through Madhya Pradesh, north Chhattisgarh and the depression over south Jharkhand and adjoining north interior Odisha. Its

alignment was close to its climatologically favourable position, a configuration typically associated with active monsoon conditions across central and eastern India.

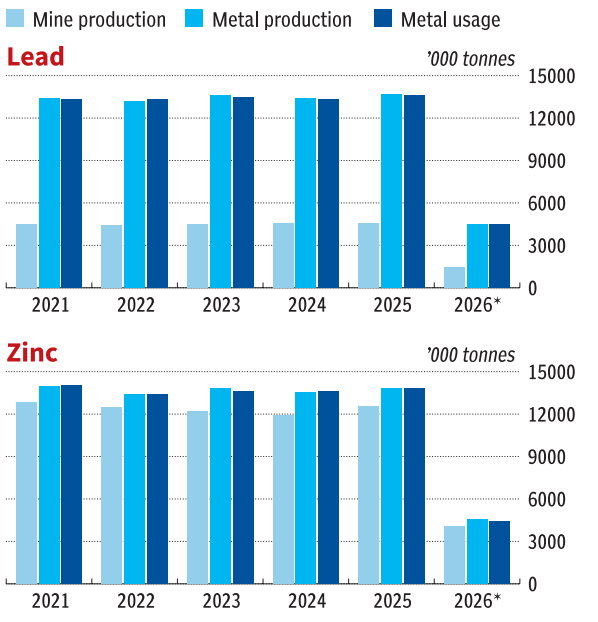
The upper-air shear zone, a corridor of strong wind discontinuity that often enhances deep convection and intense rainfall, stretched from Nashik through Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar and Chandrapur in Maharashtra to the Puri-Bhubaneswar region of Odisha. Along the West Coast, the offshore trough extended almost uninterrupted from south Gujarat to the north Kerala coast. Together, these features continue to support active monsoon conditions.

Mixed fortunes

- Global zinc mine production dropped in 2025, but its output increased. On the other hand, mine and metal output of lead increased
- The utilisation of zinc and lead increased during the year
- In 2024, zinc mine production increased, but metal production and utilisation were down
- In the case of lead, although utilisation increased, mine and metal production declined



Metal supply and usage



Source: ILZSG *Jan-Apr

Crude oil falls after OPEC+ agrees to raise output targets

Reuters

Oil prices fell on Monday after OPEC+ agreed to further increase its output targets from August while exports from key producers via the Strait of Hormuz are recovering, potentially adding to global supplies.

Brent crude futures fell 41 cents, or 0.57 per cent, to \$71.71 a barrel at 0942 GMT after settling 0.45 per cent higher on Friday. US West Texas Intermediate crude was at \$68.32 a barrel, down 37 cents, or 0.54 per cent.

There was no settlement for WTI on Friday as US markets were closed ahead of the Independence Day holiday on Saturday. The Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and their allies, including Russia, agreed on Sunday to further increase output targets by 1,88,000 barrels per day from August on top of similar increases for June and July.

Policy, energy, climate and geopolitics to influence global veg oil sector: IVPA president

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

The global vegetable oil industry is entering a new phase where policy decisions, energy markets, climate developments and geopolitics are influencing production, trade flows and price formation, according to Sudhakar Desai, President of the Indian Vegetable Oil Producers’ Association (IVPA).

Speaking at the 17th China International Conference on Oils and Oilseeds (CCOC-17) in Shanghai, he said the production of the four major vegetable oils is projected to increase by 3.1 per cent to around 212.5 million tonnes (mt) in marketing year 2025-26, while global consumption is expected to grow by 1.9 per cent to nearly 211 mt.

Although the global sup-



Sudhakar Rao Desai addressing the 17th China International Cereals and Oils Conference

ply balance remains comfortable, market direction will be shaped by policy developments and external macroeconomic factors.

Presenting his outlook for 2026, Desai said Malaysian palm oil production is expected to reach 19.8 mt, while Indonesian production is projected at 49.3 mt, a combined decline of about 9,00,000 tonnes from the previous year.

However, Indonesia may divert around 14.6 mt of palm oil towards biodiesel,

Crystal Crop and Corteva sign pact to develop, commercialise new formulations

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Crystal Crop Protection, a research-driven agriculture input company, and Corteva Ltd, a global pure-play agriculture company, have entered into a collaboration and supply agreement to develop and commercialise new formulations and mixtures.

Under this collaboration, both Crystal Crop Protection and Corteva will work together to develop, manufacture and sell India relevant crop protection products.

While Corteva will provide access to technical grade active ingredients, Crystal will develop, formulate, manufacture and sell them in India.

Quoting Ankur Aggarwal, Chairman and Managing

Director of Crystal Crop Protection, in a media statement, said: “We are pleased to collaborate with Corteva in developing new formulations and mixtures. This collaboration will help accelerate the availability of effective and farmer-centric solutions that support growers in managing key pest and weed challenges.”

KEY CHALLENGES

Subroto Geed, President-South Asia, Corteva, said: “This collaboration reflects Corteva’s commitment to advancing science-led innovation that addresses the evolving needs of Indian agriculture. By bringing together complementary strengths in technology, product development and market execution, we aim to deliver effective crop protection solutions that help farmers manage key pest

and weed challenges, improve productivity and build more resilient farming systems.”

The statement said that India cultivates nearly 48 million hectares of rice and over 13 million hectares of cotton, along with significant acreage under horticultural crops such as chilli, tomato, brinjal, okra and pomegranate, amongst other crops.

These crops are frequently affected by sucking pests, caterpillar pests, mites and diverse weed flora, resulting in yield losses and reduced farm profitability.

From shifting weather patterns to high pest and weed pressure across different regions, farmers need solutions that are reliable, safe, cost-effective and suited to local conditions, the statement said.

With natural gas move unclear, stay out for now

Gurumurthy K
BL Research Bureau

Natural gas prices have been struggling to rise strongly over the last few weeks. The Natural Gas Futures Contract traded on the Multi Commodity Exchange (MCX) has been oscillating between ₹295 and ₹320 per mmBtu for almost three weeks now. It is currently trading at ₹305 per mmBtu.

COMMODITY CALL.

OUTLOOK

The immediate outlook is unclear. But the weekly chart shows that the MCX Natural Gas Futures contract is vulnerable to break below ₹295 in the coming days. Such a break can drag the contract down to ₹285 or ₹275 thereafter.

A strong rise above ₹320 is needed to ease the downside pressure and avoid the above-mentioned fall. If that happens, ₹328-₹330 can be seen on the upside.

An eventual break above ₹330 will then clear the way for a rise to ₹340.

Overall, it is a wait and watch situation for now. A breakout on either side of ₹295-₹320 will determine the next leg of move.

TRADE STRATEGY

Since the immediate direction of move is unclear, traders can stay out of the market for now.

Fresh short positions can be considered on a break below ₹295. Keep the stop-loss at ₹299.

Trial the stop-loss down to ₹293 as soon as the contract goes down to ₹290. Revise the stop-loss lower to ₹289 when the price touches ₹287.

Deficient summer rain in South India impacted country’s tea output in May

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Tea production fell 3.54 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to 131.6 million kg (mkg) in May 2026 from 136.43 mkg a year earlier as lower output in South India due to the inadequate pre-monsoon showers weighed on overall production.

As per the Tea Board’s latest data, production in North India was up marginally at 111.72 mkg against 109.86 mkg in the same period last year, while in South India, the output was down 25 per cent at 19.88 mkg against 26.57 mkg.

In Assam, the largest producing State, output during May was down marginally at 64.70 mkg (65.04 m kg in May 2025). Production in the Assam Valley was down a



In Kerala, the production declined 16% to 5.86 mkg (7.03 mkg) due deficient rain

tad at 61.83 mkg (62.38 mkg), while Cachar saw a marginal increase in output at 2.87 mkg (2.66 mkg).

In West Bengal, production during May was up by about 5 per cent at 42.69 m kg (40.68 mkg). The increase was witnessed both in the Doorga and Terai region, whereas Darjeeling saw a marginal decline. In other producing regions of North India, tea output was up mar-

ginally at 4.33 mkg (4.14 mkg), the data showed.

OUTPUT HIT

In Tamil Nadu, the largest producing region of South India, the production dropped to 13.63 mkg during May, a 28 per cent decline over the same period last year’s 19.04 mkg.

“May was bone dry. Lack of rains in May impacted the production,” said N Lakshmanan Chettiar, a veteran planter in Coonoor.

Similarly, in Kerala, the production declined 16 per cent to 5.86 mkg (7.03 mkg) due to deficient rain.

The output in Karnataka declined to 0.39 mkg (0.5 mkg). Category-wise, the production of CTC teas stood at 116.12 mkg, while Orthodox was 13.35 mkg, and green teas accounted for the rest.

QUICKLY.
Granules gets FTF status for generic Lumryz in US



Hyderabad: Granules India has secured sole first-to-file (FTF) status for its abbreviated new drug application for sodium oxybate extended-release for oral suspension, the generic equivalent of Lumryz extended-release oral suspension. This was Granules' second sole first-to-file ANDA, following its earlier approval for amphetamine extended-release tablets, the generic of Dyanavel XR. OUR BUREAU

Glenmark launches generic Olanzapine in US

New Delhi: Glenmark Pharmaceuticals has launched the launch of the generic version of Olanzapine injection, indicated for the treatment of schizophrenia and bipolar disorder in the US. The company's arm Glenmark Pharmaceuticals Inc, USA has launched Olanzapine for injection of strength 10 mg/vial, single-dose vial, Glenmark said in a regulatory filing. PTI

Global airlines gear up to shift freighter ops to Navi Mumbai

FLIGHT PLAN. Services from the airport are expected to begin from next month

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

International airlines are negotiating office spaces and ground handling contracts as they gear up to shift freighter operations from Mumbai to Navi Mumbai airport. International passenger flights will commence from the Navi Mumbai airport on July 15 with Air India Express' Abu Dhabi service. Freight services from Navi Mumbai are expected to begin from next month as the Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) intends to temporarily suspend freighter operations. Air France, which operates two weekly freighter flights between Paris and Mumbai, said the transfer is currently planned for August 1, subject to required approvals. "We are working closely with the relevant authorities and airport stakeholders to complete all regulatory processes. At the same time, we are finalising necessary operational and handling arrangements to ensure a smooth transition," said Manuel Vaz, Air France-KLM Martinair's Cargo Director for India. Vaz said the airline is seeing healthy demand from India across a range of sectors, and its planned move to Navi Mumbai reflects commitment to support customers with reliable and future ready operations. Lufthansa Cargo said it is in constant dialogue with the



CARGO REROUTE

- MIAL intends to temporarily suspend freighter operations
- Air France says transfer is currently planned for Aug 1
- Lufthansa Cargo is in dialogue with the relevant authorities and stakeholders
- The airlines will conduct audit of the facilities at the airport before starting operations

relevant authorities and stakeholders as various aspects are still under validation. "We are working on those to inform our customers about upcoming changes as soon as possible," it said. AUDIT OF FACILITIES An industry executive said the airlines will also conduct audit of facilities at the Navi Mumbai airport before starting operations. "Loading of

cargo into the aircraft requires skill, and staff doing the job need to be well-trained and certified. It is likely that the staff in Mumbai would be transferred to Navi Mumbai but they will require new security passes." Last December, MIAL had informed airlines about its plans to suspend freighter operations from August 2026 to May 2027. The suspension is planned in order to carry out airside improvement works. The airport had then said only dedicated cargo aircraft movement will be suspended but overall cargo traffic (carried in the belly space of passenger aircraft) will continue seamlessly. Around 65 per cent of all cargo volume to Mumbai airport is carried in the belly space of passenger aircraft, it had said. Last fiscal, the Mumbai airport handled 9.27 lakh tonnes of cargo; it is the second busiest airport in India for cargo movements. The Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports did not respond to queries.

WhatsApp gets more time to reply to username notice

Press Trust of India
New Delhi



WhatsApp has assured no India rollout till the talks end

Meta-owned WhatsApp has been granted more time to submit its response on the contentious 'username' feature and has assured the government that it will not roll it out in India until the discussions are complete, according to sources. The popular messaging platform has been given three more days to file its reply to the government notice on the controversial feature as it sought more time to submit its response, sources told PTI. The username feature essentially allows people on the messaging platform to communicate without sharing their phone numbers. NOTICE TO META Last Wednesday, the Centre issued a notice to Meta, questioning the planned username feature on WhatsApp, flagging concerns that it could materially increase online fraud, phishing, digital arrest scams and impersonation attacks. It directed the platform to pause the feature until con-

sultations on the issue are completed "to the satisfaction of the government". Sources said WhatsApp had been given three more days to submit its reply to the IT Ministry. The original deadline for submission was Friday. According to sources, the platform has assured the government that it will not roll out the feature till the discussions are complete. A team from Meta met officials in the IT Ministry last Friday, following the notice summoning them. In the notice, the Centre had asked Meta to explain why action shouldn't be initiated under the IT Act and rules over WhatsApp's new feature that may increase cybercrimes. An email sent to WhatsApp did not elicit an immediate reply. A WhatsApp spokesperson

son last week said that the ability to use a username is not yet live and will roll out slowly later this year. "To protect against impersonation, we've held the highest-profile names — think public figures, government entities, celebrities, verified Meta accounts — so they can only ever be claimed by their legitimate owners and lookalike derivatives of known names are held as well," the spokesperson said. Users still require a phone number to use WhatsApp, the company had said and added that it had built multiple layers of defence against scams into usernames. "Other users need to know the exact username to message you. We will limit how many new people an account can contact, block repeated attempts to guess someone's username key, and have systems to detect and remove activity showing common impersonation and abuse patterns," it said. WhatsApp will show whether a first-time sender is a new account, contact, mutual group member or from another country before users respond.

Healthcare, education and nutrition are rights, not privileges: Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai

bl.interview

Venkatesha Babu
Bengaluru

A spiritual leader, humanitarian and social reformer, Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai is the founder of the One World One Family (Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam) Mission, a global service initiative focused on nutrition, free education and healthcare. Over the past decade, he has spearheaded the creation of a network of free schools, hospitals and nutrition programmes that today serve millions of beneficiaries. Under his leadership, the mission established India's first free rural medical college and expanded the Annapoorna Morning Nutrition Programme to over 10 million children daily. His work is guided by the belief that access to quality education, healthcare and nutrition is a fundamental human right rather than a privilege. Edited excerpts: What made you shift from being a successful investment banker to a spiritual mentor and philanthropy? Initially, Bhagawan Sri Sathya Sai Baba guided me to



When you experience the joy of transforming lives, service ceases to feel like a sacrifice — it simply becomes a way of life

SADGURU SRI MADHUSUDAN SAI
Founder, One World One Family (Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam) Mission



not be solved in isolation. They require a profound sense of shared responsibility. At One World One Family, every hospital, school and nutrition initiative is a living expression of this shared humanity. Today, our presence across 100 countries demonstrates that people everywhere respond naturally to the universal values of compassion, service and unity. Ultimately, a philosophy becomes meaningful only when it is lived.

work in the corporate world, and I followed that path sincerely. Looking back, I see that phase as preparation rather than a destination. Investment banking taught me discipline, governance, strategy and financial stewardship — lessons that seamlessly support our global humanitarian projects today. Following Baba's passing, I felt a natural, profound calling to dedicate myself entirely to his core message: Love All, Serve All. What made you focus on healthcare, nutrition and education? Universal healthcare, nutrition and education form the very foundation of human development. They are deeply interconnected: A child who is hungry cannot learn, a person who is unwell cannot contribute product-

ively, and a society without education cannot progress sustainably. When healthcare is compassionate, nutrition is accessible and education is value-based, we do more than just help individuals survive — we create responsible citizens who will go on to build a selfless, harmonious society and strengthen the nation as a whole. 'One World One Family' is an ambitious idea. How do you translate such a concept into measurable action on the ground? Many people view 'One World One Family' as a philosophical ideal, but I see it as a practical necessity. The challenges facing humanity today, such as poverty, healthcare inequality and social division, can-

What problem worries you the most today — hunger, healthcare inequality, education gaps or something else? The greatest challenge facing humanity today is not a lack of resources, but a lack of shared responsibility. The world has enough wealth, knowledge and capability, yet millions continue to suffer because our collective priorities are misaligned. What worries me most is the growing sense of separation between individuals, communities and nations. When people stop seeing each other as connected, compassion diminishes and conflict increases. The solution to this problem of separation is nurturing a sense of collective responsibility.

Inside One World One Family's nutrition mission

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

By the time seven-year-old Roshni reaches her government primary school in Rajapur, Uttar Pradesh, she already knows what she is looking forward to. Before classes begin, she joins her classmates for a glass of fortified SaiSure nutrition drink served with milk. For many children, it is the first nutritious meal of the day. "We all feel it is tasty and nutritious," she says. "Children's attendance in my school has increased because of this." Hundreds of kilometres away in Thadigol village in Karnataka's Kolar district, Class VII student Manoj Kumar speaks less about nutrition and more about what it allows him to do. "It keeps us healthy, helps us listen to our classes with interest and play with enthusiasm," he says. For decades, policymakers have debated how to improve learning outcomes in government schools. Better classrooms, trained teachers, digital learning and curriculum reforms have all been part of the conversation. Yet one of the biggest obstacles often begins long before the first lesson starts — a child ar-



HEALTHY START. The Annapoorna Morning Nutrition Programme provides a fortified nutrition drink to over 10 million government schoolchildren every day across 25 States and four Union Territories

living at school hungry. It is this problem that the Annapoorna Morning Nutrition Programme, an initiative of the One World One Family Mission, is trying to solve. NOT JUST BREAKFAST What started 13 years ago by serving breakfast to just 50 children has evolved into one of India's largest school nutrition initiatives outside the government's own programmes. Today, the programme provides a fortified morning nutrition drink to more than 10 million government school children every day across 25 States and four Union Territories. The ambition is to eventually reach nearly 80 million children. For Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai, Founder of

the One World One Family Mission, the programme has always been about much more than feeding children. "Our vision that no child should go to school hungry naturally aligns our work with the global Sustainable Development Goals," he says. "Nutrition and education are two sides of the same coin. A well-nourished child is far more likely to learn, stay in school, complete education and grow into a responsible citizen." At the centre of the programme is SaiSure, a scientifically formulated multi-nutrient health supplement fortified with vitamins and minerals. Mixed with milk or milk powder and jaggedy, and often combined with naturally grown ragi, it is served to

children before classes. According to Anand Kadali, CEO of Annapoorna Trust, collaboration has been central to its growth. "We are currently serving a morning nutrition drink to over 10 million people every day across 25 States and four Union Territories," he says. "Our goal is to reach nearly 80 million government school children affected by malnutrition." Suchetan Reddy Kotta, CEO of Global Outreach and Communications at the One World One Family Mission, believes the programme has evolved into something much larger than a charitable initiative. "What started 13 years ago with 50 children has grown into a national movement," he says. "That conviction is shared not just by one organisation, but by governments, institutions, volunteers and farming communities who have each brought their own irreplaceable contribution." As Sadguru Sri Madhusudan Sai says, "Nutrition and education are two sides of the same coin." In India's classrooms, where the future is shaped one child at a time, that coin may well begin with a warm glass of fortified ragi malt served before the first bell rings.

Riyadh Air to begin Mumbai flights from Aug 4

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Riyadh Air is launching flights to Mumbai from August 4, improving air connectivity to Saudi Arabia, India's second largest overseas destination. The airline will operate daily flights between Riyadh and Mumbai with its brand new Boeing 787 planes. Riyadh Air, which is backed by Saudi Arabia's Public Investment Fund, aspires to set up a global network rivaling its Gulf peers.



Riyadh Air CEO Tony Douglas

While traditional traffic flows comprise largely labour and pilgrims, the airline

hopes to attract onward travellers with a premium offering that includes four class cabins and modern entertainment systems, among others. "With India emerging as one of the fastest-growing aviation markets globally, we are delighted to offer travellers a new premium choice and enhanced global connectivity from Mumbai to Riyadh, and onwards to Europe," Riyadh Air CEO Tony Douglas said in a statement. "The route has been carefully selected to align with our ambition to become

a global airline and a significant contributor to Vision 2030," he added. The airline said the Mumbai-Riyadh route will offer connectivity to Europe and the Middle East, catering to both business and leisure travellers from India. Riyadh Air launched London flights on June 10, and this was followed by services to Dubai and Cairo. Flights to Madrid and Manchester will begin later this month. Around 3.4 million Indians travelled to Saudi Arabia in CY 2025, Tourism Ministry data show.

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